

PASSWITHPURPOSE

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2027
FORMAT

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

Summary Writing Workbook

Step-by-step practice for Paper 1 Question 2: the 120-word summary (15 marks) and the new 2(b) attitudes question (5 marks), with six original articles and model answers for every one.

- ◆ 6 original articles
- ◆ 5-step summary method
- ◆ Points lists for every article
- ◆ 6 model 2(b) answers
- ◆ 3 guided, 3 independent
- ◆ Own-words toolkit
- ◆ 6 model summaries (≤ 120 words)
- ◆ Mistakes page & tracker

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For exams in 2027, 2028 and 2029. Independent practice material; not produced or endorsed by Cambridge University Press & Assessment. All articles are original.

The method

Question 2 is based on Text B. Part (a) asks for a selective summary in continuous prose of no more than 120 words: 10 marks for reading (the points) and 5 for writing (clarity, concision, own words). Part (b) asks about the writer's attitudes or opinions, for 5 marks.

1 Lock the focus	Rewrite the question's focus as a heading. Only points that answer it count.
2 Harvest	Number every relevant point in the margin. Ignore examples, statistics and anecdotes unless they <i>are</i> the point.
3 Group	Merge related points under an umbrella word.
4 Write once, tightly	100–115 words, no introduction, no conclusion, no opinions.
5 Check	Count the words. Cross out any phrase copied from the text.

Own-words toolkit

Swap the phrase

- "enormous quantities" → vast amounts
- "poisoning fish" → killing wildlife
- "barely enough to live on" → extremely low
- "worn only a handful of times" → discarded after a few wears
- "wandering minds are creative ones" → a drifting mind produces original ideas
- "seek out other people" → look for company
- "no aircraft can land" → the station is cut off
- "small irritations" → minor annoyances

Use umbrella words

- water use, river pollution, plastic fibres → **environmental damage**
- low pay, long hours, unsafe buildings → **poor working conditions**
- cold, darkness, isolation → **physical and emotional hardships**
- tourists, shops, jobs → **economic benefits**

2(b): one structure, every time

ATTITUDE + EVIDENCE + EXPLANATION: "The writer is *sceptical* of fashion companies: saying they 'insist' they are changing suggests the writer does not believe them." Useful attitude words: admiring, critical, sceptical, sympathetic, dismissive, balanced, optimistic, cynical.

Five mistakes that cost summary marks

Mistake	Weak	Strong
Copying	Dyes and chemicals from factories often pour into rivers, turning them strange colours.	Factory chemicals contaminate rivers.
Examples	A single pair of jeans can require thousands of litres of water.	Producing clothes consumes vast amounts of water.
Note form	• water • chemicals • plastic • wages	Continuous prose linked with connectives: “also”, “in addition”, “finally”.
Opinions	I think fast fashion is terrible and everyone should stop buying it.	No opinions: report the text’s points only.
Too long	An introduction, every point in detail, a conclusion: 170 words.	100–115 words. Anything over 120 is not credited.

QUICK CHECK: Could someone who had never read the article understand your summary? Does every sentence answer the focus? If yes to both, you are on track.

The True Cost of Cheap Clothes

- 1 A T-shirt that costs less than a sandwich seems like a bargain. But the true cost of ‘fast fashion’ – cheap clothes produced quickly to follow the latest trends – is paid elsewhere.
- 2 The first price is paid by the environment. Making clothes uses enormous quantities of water: a single pair of jeans can require thousands of litres, much of it for growing cotton. Dyes and chemicals from factories often pour into rivers, turning them strange colours and poisoning fish. Many cheap garments are made from synthetic fabrics which shed tiny plastic fibres every time they are washed, and these fibres end up in the sea.
- 3 The second price is paid by workers. To keep prices low, many factories pay wages that are barely enough to live on, and some employees work long hours in unsafe buildings. When I visited one factory, a young woman told me she had not seen her children in daylight for a week.
- 4 The third price is paid by all of us in waste. Because fast fashion is designed to be replaced, clothes are often worn only a handful of times before being thrown away. Mountains of unwanted garments end up in landfill or are shipped abroad, where they overwhelm local markets.
- 5 Fashion companies insist they are changing, and some have introduced recycling schemes and ‘green’ collections. But these are small steps compared with the scale of production, and they often seem designed more to improve the brand’s image than to solve the problem.
- 6 Shoppers are not powerless. Buying fewer, better-made clothes, repairing what we own and shopping second-hand can all make a difference. The cheapest T-shirt, it turns out, is the one we never needed to buy.

Questions

- (a) According to the text, what are the problems caused by fast fashion? Write a summary in continuous prose, using your own words as far as possible. Your summary should be no more than **120 words**. [15]
- (b) What is the writer’s attitude towards fashion companies? Explain how you can tell. [5]